

Glossary: Introduction and Descriptive Statistics

Welcome! This alphabetized glossary contains many terms used in this course. Understanding these terms is essential when working in the industry, participating in user groups, and participating in other certificate programs.

Estimated reading time: 2 minutes

Term	Definition
Business analyst	Data professionals who bridge the gap between business objectives and technical solutions. They identify and document business requirements, conduct feasibility studies, and propose improvements to business processes.
Categorical variable	A variable that assigns each unit of observation to a group based on a qualitative property.
Cross-sectional data	A data observation from multiple subjects, such as individuals, firms, countries, or regions, at a single point in time.
Dispersion	A means of describing the extent of distribution of data around a central value or point.
Mean	The average of the given numbers. It is calculated by dividing the sum of the given numbers by the total number of numbers.
Median	A value of separating the higher value of a data sample, a population, or a probability distribution from the lower value. It is the middle value of a data set.
Mode	A value that appears most frequently in the data set.
Multivariant data set	Data sets with two or more variables.
Nominal variable	A type of categorical variable that can have two or more categories.
Quantitative relationship	Relationship between variables that are expressed in numerical values.
Skewness	A measure of the asymmetry of a statistical data distribution from a normal distribution.

Term	Definition
Standard deviation	A measure of the amount of variation or dispersion of a set of values.
Statistical analysis	A process of collecting and analyzing large amounts of data to identify trends and patterns.
Statistical tools	Tools by which statistical methods are applied.
Statistics	A branch of study that helps to analyze, interpret, and present data.
Univariant data set	Data sets with one variable.

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